VERBAL

Critical Reasoning

Strengthening, Weakening & Wrong assumptions

eBOOK

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Critical Reasoning – E-Book

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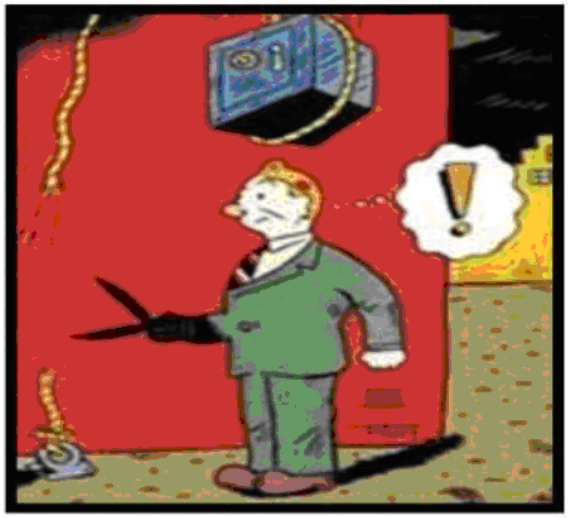
1.1 Introduction

What is critical reasoning all about? It is basically about arguments and their validity. An argument is a group of statements; one is supposed to follow from the others, which are regarded as providing support or grounds for the truth. This is called the conclusion of the argument. The statement(s) that provide the support or reasons for accepting the conclusion are the premises.

Conclusion: A conclusion is a claim, the main point of an argument.

Facts or Premises: A premise is a stated reason, a piece of evidence that supports the conclusion.
Assumption: An assumption is an unstated premise that supports the conclusion.



This man is not thinking critically

Consider the following sample argument:

United Artists most recent film is based on a best-selling novel and stars Brad Heartthrob. Therefore, the film is expected to do well at the box office.

The first step in tackling a problem such as this is to identify the three components.

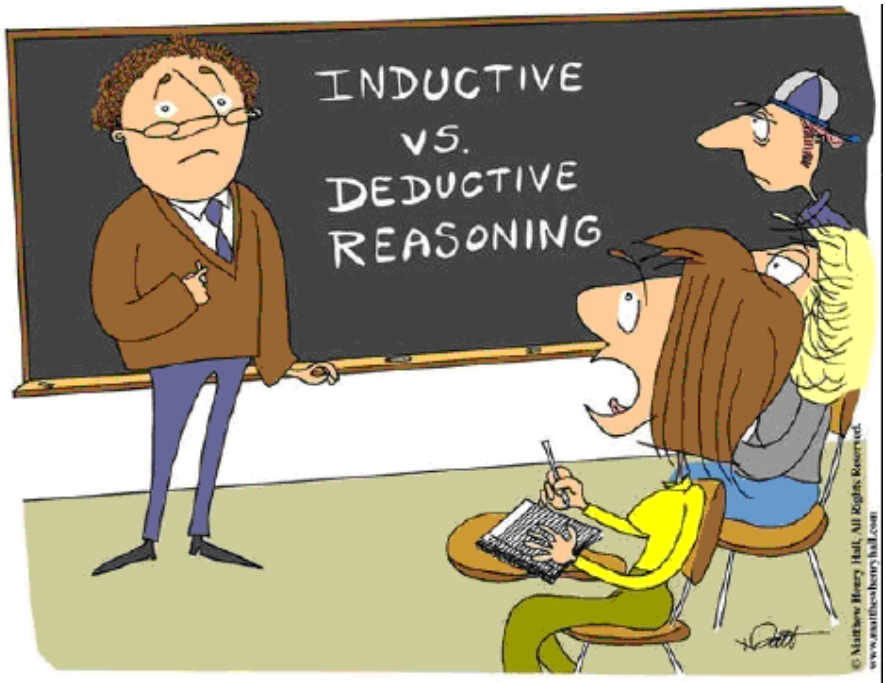
Fact 1: Film based on popular novel
Fact 2: Star is Brad Heartthrob

Conclusion: Film should be successful

The assumptions are always unstated (hereafter, Hidden Assumptions, or Hidden Assumption's): they are additional pieces of information about each fact in the argument. For example:

Hidden Assumption for fact 1: Fans of the book are expected to help sales of tickets.
Hidden Assumption for fact 2: Brad Heartthrob's presence should contribute to the success of film.

These Hidden Assumption's help you see how the facts lead to the conclusion. You can often, though not always, distinguish fact from conclusion by spotting "signal words" that introduce each component. The Conclusions may be signaled by words like as, therefore (as in the example above), so, thus, and in conclusion. Detailed facts, which are more specific than conclusions, may be flagged by such words as due to, because, a study shows, and in addition.



"So inductive reasoning is like when someone unfriends you on Facebook, but you know it's because his girlfriend's jealous, and it really means he wants to hook up. Or is that deductive reasoning?"

Once you identify the components, you must answer questions that ask you to evaluate these components. There are three basic question types in the Logical Reasoning section, each focusing on one of the three components. They are in descending order of frequency: the Additional Fact Questions, the Conclusion Question, and the Hidden Assumption Question.

A. Some of the questions will merely ask you to identify the conclusion.

B. Additional Fact/ Inference questions - these ask you to find something that is known to be true from information presented in the argument containing words like - *infer, implicit, imply, most reasonably* and *must be true*. Inferences could be about a conclusion that was not stated, or from facts stated as premises.

C. Assumption questions – These use phrases like depends on, relies on, assumes. Look for a gap between the premises and the conclusion, try to get a sense of what assumption is necessary to fill the gap. Try to state the assumption in your own words before seeing the answer choices.

2.1 Identifying Conclusions Quiz

***Identify the conclusion in the arguments expressed in questions 1-11*:**

1. The FDA should stop all cigarette sales immediately. After all, cigarette smoking is the leading preventable cause of death.

2. Every law is an evil, for every law is an infraction of liberty.

3. Wisdom is the principal thing, therefore get wisdom.

4. Now human law is framed for a multitude of human beings. The majority of human beings are not perfect in virtue. Therefore human laws do not forbid all vices.

5. ... vicious acts are contrary to acts of virtue. But human laws does not prohibit all vices... Therefore neither does it prescribe all acts of virtue.

6. The real and original source of inspiration for the Muslim thinkers was the Quran and the sayings of the Holy Prophet. It is therefore clear that the Muslim philosophy was not a carbon copy of Greek thought, as it concerned itself primarily and specifically with those problems which originated from and had relevance to Muslims.

7. Letting forests die is self destructive. Their role as a filter of the world's pollution, a sponge that absorbs carbon dioxide and slows global warming is crucial to the life of the earth.

8. As the government spends increasingly less on student financial aid, many leading colleges and universities are using a larger percentage of tuition revenues for scholarships. Just as income tax breaks are given for charitable contributions, this portion of the tuition should be tax deductible.

9. If the criminal law prohibits suicide, that is not an argument valid in the church; and besides, the prohibition is ridiculous; for what penalty can frighten a person who is not afraid of death itself?

10. If a right to euthanasia is grounded in self determination, it cannot be reasonably limited to the terminally ill. If people have a right to die, why must they wait till they are dying before they are permitted to exercise that right?

11. The dreamer rejected the ordinary. Jay invited the ordinary. Jay was no dreamer.

Questions 12-21 are excerpts from TED talks. In your own words, write down the conclusions made by the passage. *And btw, if you loved the passage, you can watch the TED talk by clicking on the hyperlink below ☺*

12. I learned that it all changes in an instant. We have this bucket list, we have these things we want to do in life, and I thought about all the people I wanted to reach out to that I didn't, all the fences I wanted to mend, all the experiences I wanted to have and I never did. As I thought about that later on, I came up with a saying, which is, "I collect bad wines." Because if the wine is ready and the person is there, I'm opening it. I no longer want to postpone anything in life. And that urgency, that purpose, has really changed my life.

To access this TED talk by Ric Elias click on this

13. Also is the knowledge that right now we spend about in the first 25 years of our lives learning, then there is another 40 years that's really reserved for working. And then tacked on at the end of it are about 15 years for retirement. And I thought it might be helpful to basically cut off five of those retirement years and intersperse them in between those working years. (Applause) That's clearly enjoyable for myself. But probably even more important is that the work that comes out of these years flows back into the company and into society at large, rather than just benefiting a grandchild or two.

Excerpted from TED talk by Stefan Sagmeister

14. We are constantly trying to put accountability in someone's hands. Who is accountable for this process? We need somebody accountable for this process. So in the relay race, since passing the baton is so important, then we need somebody clearly accountable for passing the baton. So between each runner, now we will have a new dedicated athlete, clearly dedicated to taking the baton from one runner, and passing it to the next runner. And we will have at least two like that. Well, will we, in that case, win the race? That I don't know, but for sure, we would have a clear interface, a clear line of accountability. We will know who to blame. But we'll never win the race. If you think about it, we pay more attention to knowing who to blame in case we fail, than to creating the conditions to succeed. All the human intelligence put in organization design -- urban structures, processing systems -- what is the real goal? To have somebody guilty in case they fail. We are creating organizations able to fail, but in a compliant way, with somebody clearly accountable when we fail. And we are quite effective at that -- failing.

Excerpted from TED talk by Yves Morieux

15. Change has to first start in the mind. If we think back to our pitch to Bob, in order to apply the principles that underpin the miracle of the human immune system, we first need to think differently about business. Now typically, when we think about business, we use what I call "mechanical thinking." We set goals, we analyze problems, we construct and we adhere to plans, and more than anything else, we stress efficiency and short-term performance. Now, don't get me wrong -- this is a splendidly practical and effective way of addressing relatively simple challenges in relatively stable environments. It's the way that Bob -- and probably many of us, myself included -- process most business problems we're faced with every day. In fact, it was a pretty good mental model for business -- overall -- until about the mid-1980s, when the conjunction of globalization and a revolution in technology and telecommunications made business far more dynamic and unpredictable.

Excerpted from TED talk by Martin Reeves

16. How do you solve a really complex problem?

For example, you try to make a jet engine. There are lots and lots of different variables, the operating temperature, the materials, all the different dimensions, the shape. You can't solve that kind of problem all in one go, it's too hard. So what do you do? Well, one thing you can do is try to solve it step-by-step. So you have some kind of prototype and you tweak it, you test it, you improve it. You tweak it, you test it, you improve it. Now, this idea of marginal gains will eventually get you a good jet engine. And it's been quite widely implemented in the world. So you'll hear about it, for example, in high performance cycling, web designers will talk about trying to optimize their web pages, they're looking for these step-by-step gains.

That's a good way to solve a complicated problem. But you know what would make it a better way? A dash of mess. You add randomness, early on in the process, you make crazy moves, you try stupid things that shouldn't work, and that will tend to make the problem-solving work better. And the reason for that is the trouble with the step-by-step process, the marginal gains, is they can walk you gradually down a dead end. And if you start with the randomness, that becomes less likely, and your problem-solving becomes more robust.

Excerpted from TED talk by Tim Harford

17. I have questions with the values of Newtonian science, like rationality. You're supposed to be rational in an argument. Well rationality is constructed by what Christie Hefner was talking about today, that mind-body split, you know? The head is good, body bad. Head is ego, body id. When we say "I," -- as when Rene Descartes said, "I think therefore I am," -- we mean the head. And as David Lee Roth sang in "Just a Gigolo," "I ain't got no body." That's how you get rationality. And that's why so much of humor is the body asserting itself against the head. That's why you have toilet humor and sexual humor.

Excerpted from TED talk by Emily Levine

18. "The first question which you will ask and which I must try to answer is this: What is the use of climbing Mt. Everest? And my answer must at once be, it is no use. There is not the slightest prospect of any gain whatsoever. Oh, we may learn a little about the behavior of the human body at high altitudes, and possibly medical men may turn our observation to some account for the purposes of aviation, but otherwise nothing will come of it. We shall not bring back a single bit of gold or silver, and not a gem, nor any coal or iron. We shall not find a single foot of earth that can be planted with crops to raise food. So it is no use. If you cannot understand that there is something in man which responds to the challenge of this mountain and goes out to meet it, that the struggle is the struggle of life itself upward and forever upward, then you won't see why we go. What we get from this adventure is just sheer joy, and joy, after all, is the end of life. We don't live to eat and make money. We eat and make money to be able to enjoy life. That is what life means, and that is what life is for."

Excerpted from TED talk by Ben Saunders

19. Leadership is a choice. It is not a rank. I know many people at the senior-most levels of organizations who are absolutely not leaders. They are authorities, and we do what they say because they have authority over us, but we would not follow them. And I know many people who are at the bottoms of organizations who have no authority and they are absolutely leaders, and this is because they have chosen to look after the person to the left of them, and they have chosen to look after the person to the right of them. This is what a leader is.

Excerpted from TED talk by Simon Sinek

20. There are advantages to Income-Based Tuition. By tying the cost to the income, college administrators would be forced to manage costs better, to find innovative ways to do so. For instance, all of you students here pay roughly the same tuition for every major. That is manifestly unfair, and should change. An engineering student uses more resources and facilities and labs and faculty than a philosophy student. But the philosophy student, as a consequence, is subsidizing the engineering student. Who then, by the way, goes on and earns more money. Why should two people buy the same product, pay the same, but one person receive half or a third of the service. In fact, college grads, some majors, pay 25 percent of their income servicing their student debt, while others pay five percent. That kind if inequity would end when majors are priced more correctly.

Excerpted from TED talk by Sajay Samuel

21. If you think about Adam Smith versus Karl Marx, Adam Smith had a very important notion of efficiency. He gave an example of a pin factory. He said pins have 12 different steps, and if one person does all 12 steps, production is very low. But if you get one person to do step one, and one person to do step two and step three and so on, production can increase tremendously. And indeed, this is a great example, and the reason for the Industrial Revolution and efficiency. Karl Marx, on the other hand, said that the alienation of labor is incredibly important in how people think about the connection to what they are doing. And if you do all 12 steps, you care about the pin. But if you do one step every time, maybe you don't care as much.

I think that in the Industrial Revolution, Adam Smith was more correct than Karl Marx. But the reality is that we've switched, and now we're in the knowledge economy. You can ask yourself, what happens in a knowledge economy? Is efficiency still more important than meaning? I think the answer is no. I think that as we move to situations in which people have to decide on their own about how much effort, attention, caring, how connected they feel to it, are they thinking about labor on the way to work, and in the shower and so on, all of a sudden Marx has more things to say to us. So when we think about labor, we usually think about motivation and payment as the same thing, but the reality is that we should probably add all kinds of things to it -- meaning, creation, challenges, ownership, identity, pride, etc.

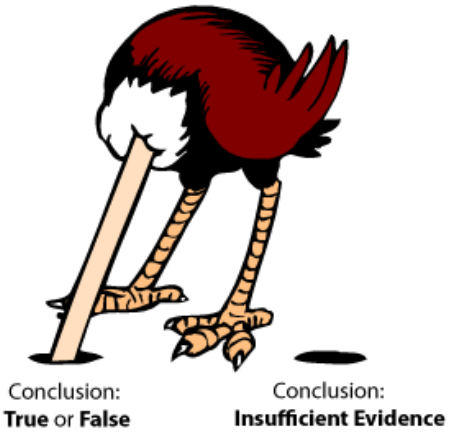
Excerpted from TED talk by Dan Ariely

CLICK HERE FOR CHECKING YOUR ANSWERS.

3.1 Types of Fallacies

Most often questions check the knowledge of being able to pick holes in arguments. The various types of fallacies are:

Ignorance



A statement is true simply because it has not been proved false or vice versa. Appeal to Ignorance occurs when a person mistakenly believes something to be true that is not, because he or she does not know enough about the subject, or has not been given enough evidence, to know otherwise. For example, an argument based on stereotype is an example of ignorance fallacy. Such an argument is persuasive because the audience wants to believe what their prejudice tells them is true.

Since the new drug showed no adverse effects on mice, it has no adverse effects on humans.

No one can actually prove that God exists; therefore God does not exist.

The doctors can't explain how she woke from the coma so it must have been the power of our prayers.

Inappropriate Authority

All of us depend on things that other people tell us. Children rely on their parents and teachers for basic guidance and instruction. Scientists rely on other scientists to report their findings accurately. Historians depend on primary sources and other historians for reliable information about the past. Indeed, it is hard to see how any stable and cohesive society could exist without a great deal of shared trust in its members' basic honesty and reliability. For that reason, trust in authority has aptly been described as "the very foundation of civilization." Too often, however, people rely uncritically on the authority of others. Throughout history blind faith in authority has bred superstition, intolerance, and dogmatism. Consequently, it is of great importance to

be able to distinguish legitimate appeals to authority from those that are fallacious. The fallacy of inappropriate appeal to authority is committed when an arguer cites a witness or authority who, there is good reason to believe, is unreliable.

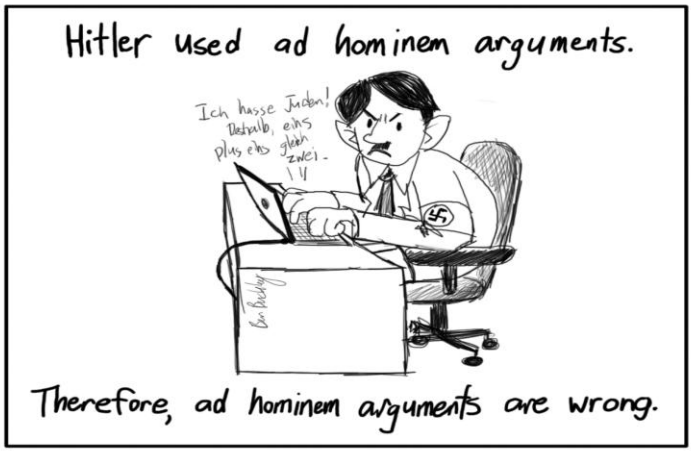
> Drive a Ford Escort because the famous tennis star Leander Paes drives one.
>
> Oppenheimer concluding that nuclear weapons is a wrong political decision.

Circular Reasoning

The circular argument uses its own conclusion as one of its stated or unstated premises. Instead of offering proof, it simply asserts the conclusion in another form, thereby inviting the listener to accept it as settled when, in fact, it has not been settled. Because the premise is no different from and therefore as questionable as its conclusion, a circular argument violates the criterion of acceptability.

> To allow every man unbounded freedom of speech must always be, on the whole, advantageous to the state; for it is highly conducive to the interest of the community that each individual should enjoy a liberty, perfectly unlimited, of expressing his sentiments.
>
> I know what the author says is true, because he states in the preface that he does not lie.

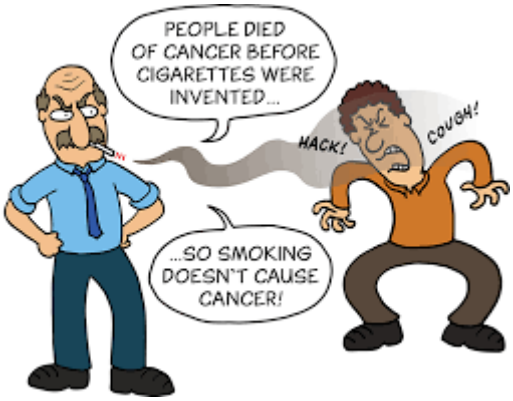
Ad Hominem



An ad hominem argument is one that is used to counter another argument; but, it is based on feelings or prejudice, rather than facts, reason or logic. It is often a personal attack on one's character rather than an attempt to address the issue at hand. This type of fallacy can often be witnessed in usage in individual debate, in court or in politics. Often, the attack is based on one's social, political, or religious views, or is based on lifestyle choices of the person being attacked using ad hominem.

> Cardinal Newman's claims were not to be trusted, because being a Roman Catholic priest, Newman's first loyalty was not to the truth.
> This is a female issue. As a man, how can you have an opinion about this?
> You wouldn't understand since you have never had to struggle.

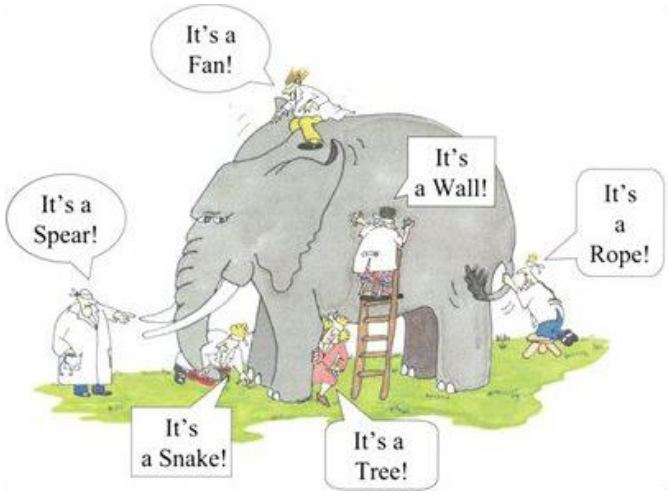
Sampling



Wrong to make a generalization - or make a specific conclusion from a generalization. Eating deep fried foods has a generally adverse impact on one's cholesterol level, but that bad outcome may not arise in some persons, so can we claim that eating fried foods is not bad? It is a broad claim based on too-limited evidence. It is unethical to assert a broad claim when you have only anecdotal or isolated evidence or instances.

> It rained yesterday and today. Therefore it will rain tomorrow
>
> An environmental group illegally blocked loggers and workers at a nuclear plant. Therefore, environmentalists are radicals who take the law into their own hands.

Part-Whole

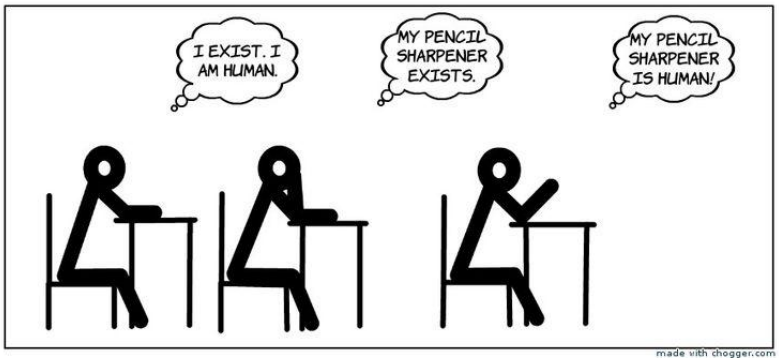


The error of assuming that what is true of a member of a group is true for the group as a whole.

Since every part of the machine is light in weight, the machine is light weight.

The atomic bombs dropped during WWII did more damage than did the ordinary bombs that were dropped. (individually or collectively?)

Bad Syllogism



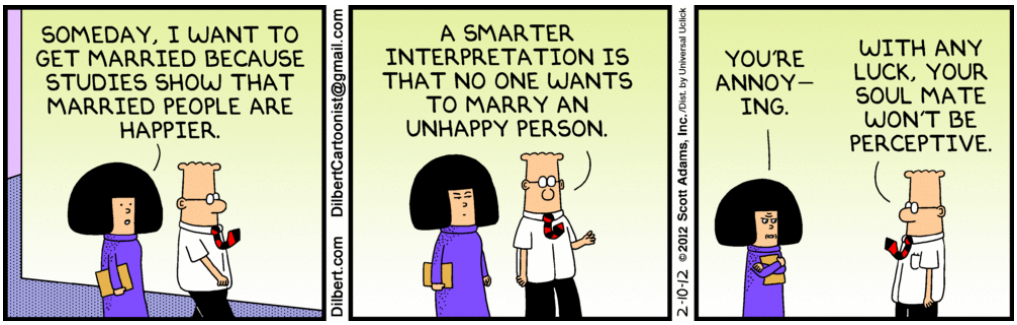
Use Venn Diagram approach to decide if a syllogism follows.

False Analogy

Analogies and metaphors can be very useful to *explain* things to people and often play an important part in learning. A false analogy is a logical fallacy that occurs when someone applies facts from one situation to another situation but the situations are substantially different and the same conclusions cannot logically be drawn.

> The universe is like a watch. A watch must have a watchmaker. The universe, being like a watch, must have a designer.

Correlation not Cause



That "correlation proves causation," is considered questionable when two events occurring together are taken to have established a cause-and-effect relationship.

> In a series of experiments from 1924-1932, researchers studied the worker productivity effects associated with altering the Illinois factory's environment, including changing light levels, tidying up the place and moving workstations around. Just when they thought they were on to something, they noticed a problem: The observed increases in productivity flagged almost as soon as the researchers left the works, indicating that the workers' knowledge of the experiment, not the researchers' changes, had fueled the boost. Researchers still call this phenomenon the Hawthorne Effect.

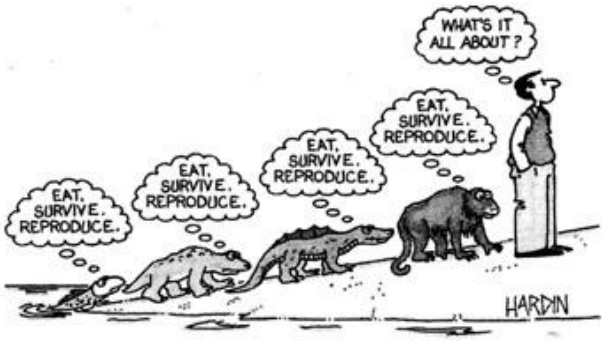
Ambiguity

These are fallacies that occur because of the ambiguous or unclear use of language.

An elephant is an animal, so a small elephant is a small animal. “definition of small is relative”.

Why do white sheep eat more than black sheep? “because there are more of them” (sheep was plural)

Complex Question



Asking the question in such a way as to presuppose the truth of some conclusion in that question.

Why is the private development of resources so much more efficient than any government owned enterprise?

Or asking two questions at one go and expecting an answer in the negative or affirmative at one go.

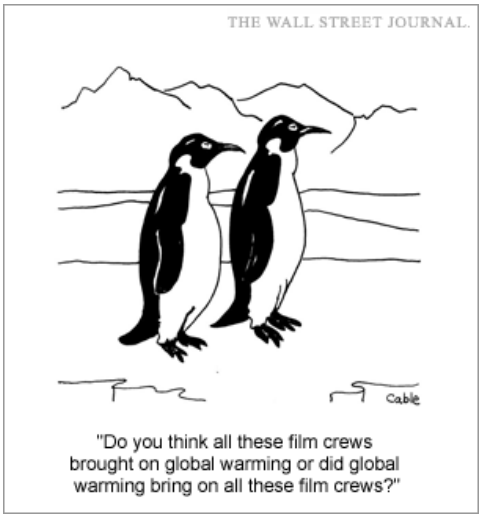
Were you at home at 9 p.m.? Did you come home early on the day that the murder was committed?

3.2 Identifying Fallacies quiz

Identify the type of fallacy expressed in the 15 cartoons below:

1.

2.



3.

4.

"LOTS OF THINGS ARE INVISIBLE, BUT WE DON'T KNOW HOW MANY BECAUSE WE CAN'T SEE THEM."

5.

6.

Can we let a shrimp like this run our great country?

7.

SON, MAN IS THE ONLY ANIMAL THAT KILLS FOR SPORT!
JOHNSON
THAT'S NOT TRUE!
5/18
WALRUSES KILL PENGUINS FOR NO APPARENT REASON OTHER THAN FUN!
ANOTHER '60 S BROMIDE BITES THE DUST!

8.

IF THE SIGN SAYS FINE FOR DUMPING THEN THAT'S GOOD ENOUGH FOR ME !!
FINE FOR DUMPING

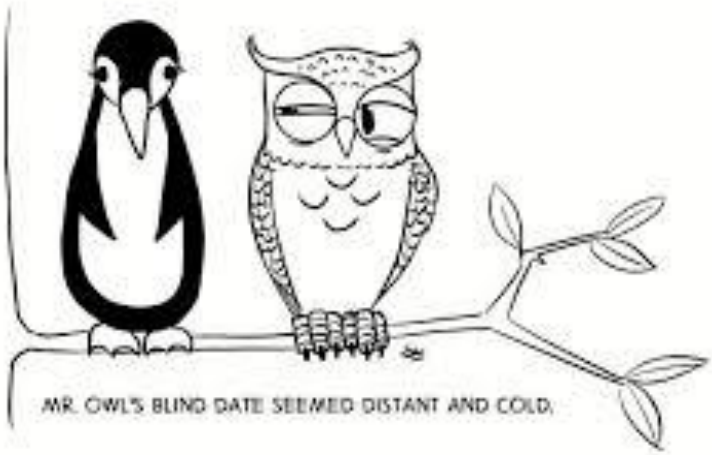
9.

WHAT DO YOU THINK HAPPENS TO YOU WHEN YOU DIE?
GOOGLE IT.
GUYS, GOOGLE ISN'T SOME ALL-POWERFUL, ALL-KNOWING GOD...THERE ARE CERTAIN THINGS THAT NOT EVEN GOOGLE CAN HELP YOU WITH.
WHICH THINGS ARE THOSE?
GOOGLE IT.
I GIVE UP.
ALL PRAISE TO THE GOOGLE!!

10.

They're paper clips! You can't make something beautiful out of paper clips!

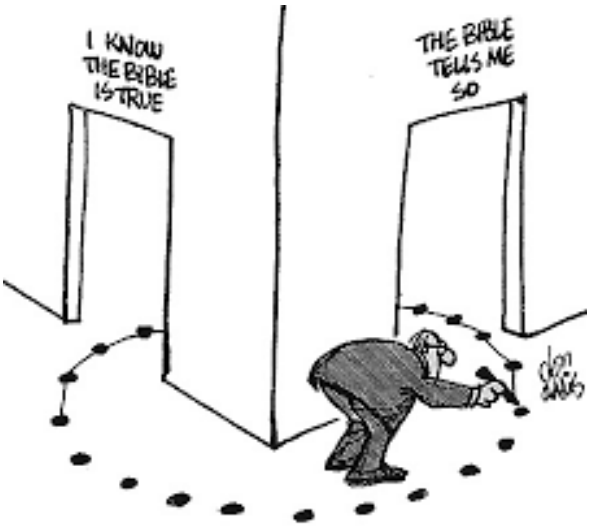
11.



12.

13.

14.



15.

CLICK HERE FOR CHECKING YOUR ANSWERS

4.1 Technique for Critical Reasoning

The general algorithm to be used in answering any critical reasoning questions is:

1. Identify the conclusion. In some cases, the question can take the forms of a fill-in-the-blank, in which case the conclusion would be part of the option.
2. Ask yourself this question. What is evidence in the argument itself, which is supporting the conclusion? This would be explicitly stated in the argument.
3. The next question that you will need to address. Is the conclusion dependent upon some conditions that have not been stated explicitly in the passage? If that is the case, try to list down such assumptions.
4. Look at the question and try to frame an answer to the question, as far as possible without looking at the options.

The best possible suggestion for doing well on Critical Reasoning is to understand how the problems are constructed, what the test is asking you to do, and then to practice. Keep in mind the following steps when tackling this section in the test.

Read each paragraph carefully.

A. Distinguish conclusion from fact and consider the hidden assumptions based on given facts.

B. Read the question carefully.

C. For additional fact questions, make sure of your task (strengthen or weaken) before proceeding. Choose the statement that directly addresses a given fact, Hidden Assumption, or conclusion.

D. For conclusion questions, think in a linear fashion: Where are the facts headed? Choose a statement that goes one logical step further from the given facts.

E. For Hidden Assumption questions, remember to choose a statement that supports the argument with more information about given issues. Try the “negation test.”

5.1 Additional Fact Questions

Types of Questions

The Additional Fact questions focus on the supporting details of the argument. You are presented with a complete argument and are asked either to weaken or strengthen the argument by considering five multiple-choice statements. These statements are new facts about the argument, which you must accept as true.

Some additional fact questions ask for a weakening of argument, while others might ask you to support the argument.

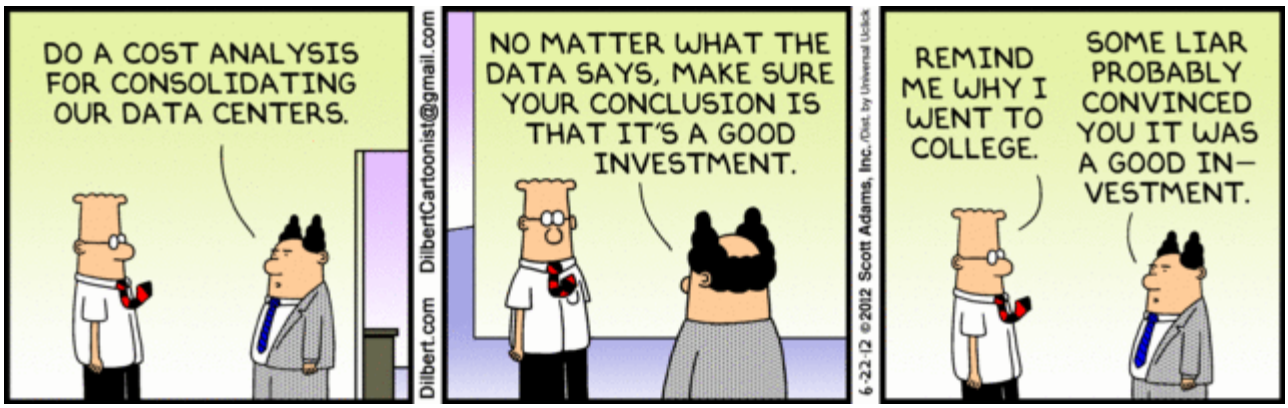
For example, in the preceding argument regarding United Artists' new movie, an Additional Fact Question might offer the following choices:

1. The film will play only in urban areas.
2. The producers of the film have cast their next movie without Brad H.
3. The film is not likely to win an Academy Award.
4. The book upon which the film is based is a worldwide hit.
5. Brad H's popularity ratings are at an all-time low.

If the question asks you to weaken the argument, you will choose a statement that either weakens a given fact or disputes Hidden Assumption and makes the conclusion illogical. Option 5 best weakens this argument by disputing the Hidden Assumption that Brad H. will attract moviegoers. The conclusion no longer logically follows.

For a strengthening choice, you would choose a statement to bolster a given fact or Hidden Assumption to support the conclusion. The correct strengthening option here would be 4, for it elaborates the book's popularity, thus supporting the conclusion. Wrong choices, called distracters, usually follow a pattern. They may touch upon the argument only marginally (such as answers 1, 2, & 3): they may accomplish the opposite task (strengthen when you want to weaken); or they may not be the best strengthening or weakening statement (e.g. option 1 is not the best weakening statement when compared to 5)

Try the questions on the page that follow.



1. The trend in the United States banking industry of several small community banks merging into fewer large, interstate banks has consumers worried about service. Many consumers worry that, as banks become larger and fewer in number, the competition in the banking industry will decrease, and consumers will lose services and will pay higher fees. As a result, many consumers are urging their legislators to enact legislation to limit the size of any individual banking company.

Which of the following facts would most allay the fears of the consumers discussed in the preceding argument?

1. The federal government recently enacted legislation to increase the maximum amounts of deposits that will be insured.
2. A limitation on mergers between interstate banks could be construed as a violation of the Commerce Clause of the United States Constitution.
3. Larger banks are able to generate higher profits for their investors with lower levels of risk.
4. As a bank increases in size, its overhead costs for operation will decrease, and it will be able to improve the services to its consumers.
5. Large governmentally operated banks have functioned successfully in other countries for many years without any decrease in services to their consumers, and with service fees that are less than many private banks.

2. Of the graduating students from Governor Smith Academy, a private high school, 93 percent go on to college. From Eastern High, the public high school in the same city, only 74 percent go on to attend college. As a result, many parents with children about to enter high school believe that Governor Smith Academy gives students a better education than they can get at Easter High School.

Which of the following statements, if true, would cast the most doubt on the conclusion about Governor Smith Academy?

1. Until 1992, Governor Smith Academy was exclusively a girl's school, but Eastern High School has always been coeducational.
2. Governor Smith Academy requires students to pass an admission examination before entering, but Eastern High School admits all applicants who live in the city.
3. Eastern High School has problems with student violence during school hours.
4. Governor Smith Academy has a higher percentage of students attending Ivy League colleges than any other high school in the state.

3. Television Advertisement: “Leonardo da Vinci was a genius, and everyone recognizes his art as the greatest in the world. At Acme Art Supply Company, you can get modern, improved art supplies, so you will be able to create works of art better than Leonardo da Vinci's.”

Which of the following statements, if true, most shows the flaws in the claims made in this advertisement?

1. Leonardo da Vinci, at the time he was painting in the fifteenth century, was sponsored by patrons who provided him with the opportunity to use the best materials then available in the world.
2. Most of the customers of Acme Art Supply Company are hobbyists who are not professionally trained and who do not realize the value of using professional-quality art supplies.
3. The art supplies at Acme Art Supply Company are more expensive than similar supplies available at any other supply store in the area.
4. An art professor from the local community college supplies all of his students with materials from the Acme Art Supply Company.
5. Even when using supplies from Acme Art Supply Company, many amateur artists create projects that art critics call inferior and childish.

4. While some job loss is inevitable in a changing American economy, the current phase of corporate "downsizing" has reached the level of becoming an epidemic. Many employees are being fired simply to enhance profits for top management and company shareholders. Even so, some economists see improvement in the fact that the total number of new jobs being created is increasing at a steady rate.

Which of the following facts, if true would show that the economists' view of improvement is incorrect?

1. The new jobs that are being created come as a result of Governmental tax incentives to large corporations.
2. Corporate downsizing is not actually resulting in higher profits for shareholders as expected.
3. Many of the new jobs are low-paying entry-level positions that do not provide health care or pension benefits.
4. A separate study of corporate shareholders reveals that many of them would be willing to forgo higher profits in order to increase hiring levels.
5. Other countries are experiencing similar increases in job creation.

5. High doses of niacin in a person's diet have been shown to raise HDL levels, which doctors call the "good" cholesterol, and to lower levels of triglycerides and LDL, the so-called "bad" cholesterol. As a result of this study, some nutritionists are now recommending diets that are extremely high in niacin.

Which of the following facts, if true, would most question the recommendations of the nutritionists?

1. The original study was conducted on a sample of hospital patients who initially had dangerously high cholesterol levels.
2. High doses study was conducted on a sample of hospital patients who initially had dangerously high cholesterol levels.
3. When level of triglycerides decrease, patients report higher levels of stamina and improved physical endurance.
4. The doctors reporting the results of the study had once been discredited for falsifying the results of their research.
5. Other studies have shown that the body eventually reaches a maximum plateau with regard to its LDL level.

CLICK HERE FOR CHECKING YOUR ANSWERS

5.2 Conclusion Questions

Read the question first to decide what the question is asking. Do not read the choices. Then read the argument passage. As you read look for the conclusion. The conclusion often comes after words like: therefore, thus, hence, then, consequently, as a result. State what you think is the conclusion and then ask, “Why?” The other statements should provide the reasons. If not then you have chosen the wrong part as the conclusion. The premises answer the question “Why?” Certain words that generally introduce a premise are: because, since, if, given that, in view of, assume, suppose.

At times, arguments will be missing their conclusion. A series of facts, along with unstated Hidden Assumption's will lead to the final statement, which you must supply. Sound arguments are linear, in that you can usually predict in what general direction the facts are headed. You may also consider the conclusion an inference: you are inferring the conclusion from the specific statements and associated Hidden Assumptions.

The newest book by England's favorite political satirist has received warm praise from critics. In addition, there is a strong market in the U.K. for political satire.

You are now asked to choose the statement that best completes this series of facts.

1. Political satire transfers well to other countries.
2. The author of this book is a member of Parliament.
3. People read book reviews before making purchases.
4. Such a book will be banned by the current Tory government.
5. The book will do well in British Bookstores.

Although a series of facts does not usually have just one possible conclusion, there is only one best conclusion in the given choices. The best answer here would be one that follows the path that the facts follow, by making a more general statement. The answer is (5).

Distracters may read too much into the facts; In the preceding example, statement (4) is a choice that goes too far from the given facts; you cannot reach the conclusion from the facts alone. Another sort of distracter introduces more detail instead of making the leap to a conclusion; examples of this would be answer (1), (2), and (3).

Now try these:

6. A consumer watchdog group recently reported the results of a study surrounding the deregulation of the U.S. banking industry, which has allowed for more mergers between banks and has allowed banks more freedom in setting their interest rates for their customers. The report shows that customers now have access to higher savings interest rates and lower borrowing interest rates. At the same time, banks, are reporting record profits.

From the results of this study, what can be concluded about the effect of deregulation of the American banking industry?

1. Deregulation has hurt the banking industry by limiting the number of options allowed to the customers of small, local banks.
2. Deregulation has been a success because it has given the banks the ability to raise their interest rates and force their customers to pay the highest rates possible.
3. As a result of the deregulation of the banking industry, investments in other industries will increase resulting in a stronger economy nationwide.
4. Deregulation has been a success because it allows both the banks and their customers to realize savings and profits at the same time.
5. Because deregulation has lowered the interest rates that customers will have to pay, many banks will be driven out of business in the near future.

7. A report from the head of the city's school department reveals that the school department had a larger surplus in its health insurance account at the end of 1994.

The same report showed that at the end of 1995 the school department suffered a deficit of $300,000 in the same account. Despite this decline, the school department reported no significant changes in costs over the two-year period.

What can be concluded from the results of this report?

1. The school department's budget for health costs is excessively high.
2. More teachers were provided with health insurance payments during 1995 than in 1994.
3. The costs related to operating the school department's health insurance program must have increased dramatically from 1994 to 1995.
4. The health insurance account received less funding in 1995 than it did in 1994
5. The health insurance budget will show an even greater deficit in 1996 than it did in 1995.

8. In a game of Monopoly, if a player owns a hotel on Boardwalk, he must own both Boardwalk and Park Place. If he owns a hotel in Marvin Gardens, he must own Marvin Gardens.

If the player described above does not own Park Place, which of the following conclusions may be drawn?

1. The player owns a hotel on Boardwalk.
2. The player owns a hotel in Marvin Gardens but does not own a hotel on Boardwalk.
3. The Player owns Marvin Gardens and Boardwalk, but does not own a hotel on either property.
4. The player does not own a hotel in Marvin Gardens.
5. The player does not own a hotel on Boardwalk.

9. As the temperature of a solution of water and chemical X increases, the reactivity of chemical Y increases but the reactivity of chemical X remains constant. As the temperature of a solution of water and chemical Y increases, the reactivity of chemical Y remains constant.
From the above information, what conclusion may be drawn?

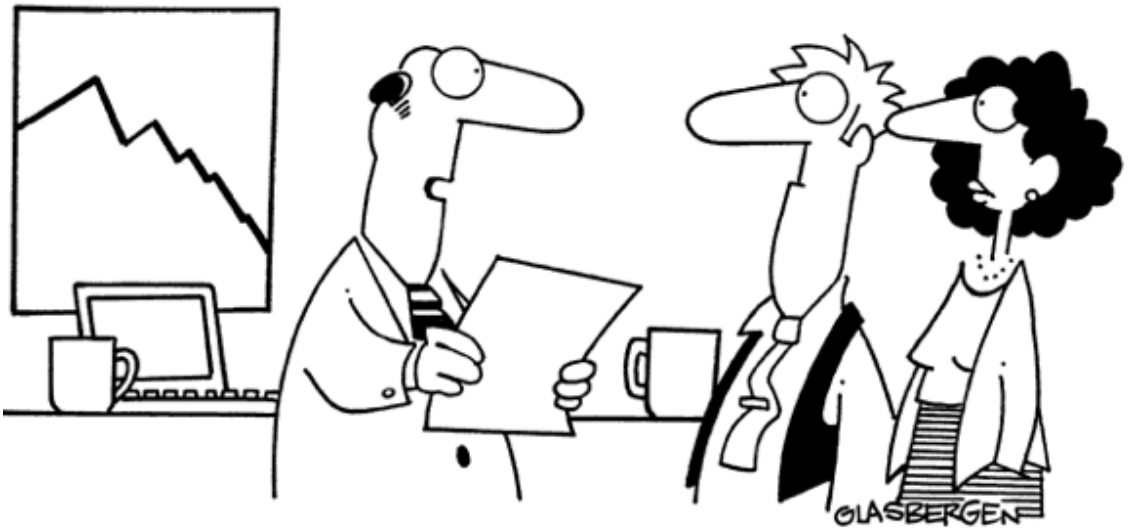
1. A change in temperature has no effect on the reactivity of chemical Y.
2. A change in temperature of chemical Y causes a reduction in the temperature of chemical X.
3. When combined, chemical X and chemical Y display different reaction levels than when studied separately.

4. When combined with chemical X, chemical Y demonstrates the same reactive properties as it does when it is studied alone.
5. A change in temperature produces a greater effect on chemical Y than it does on chemical X.

10. Advertisement**:** Seven out of ten municipal employees choose Green Arrow Underwriters as their health insurance provider.

From the information provided in this advertisement, what further conclusion may be drawn?

1. Green Arrow Underwriters has the cheapest premium rated of any other insurance company available.
2. All other health insurance providers, excluding Green Arrow Underwriters, provide services to less than 50 percent of the municipal employees.
3. Municipal employees need less health insurance coverage than employees in other industries.
4. Green Arrow Underwriters provides more valuable services and better customer assistance than any of its competitors.
5. Except for Green Arrow Underwriters, the health insurance industry is suffering a decline in the rate of obtaining new customers.



**"Thinking outside of the box didn't work.
Thinking inside of the box didn't work.
Maybe it's a defective box!"**

CLICK HERE FOR CHECKING YOUR ANSWERS

5.3 Assumption Questions

To tackle the Hidden Assumption question, you must directly face the hidden statements that underlie the argument. Each Hidden Assumption statement meets the following two criteria: it gives you extra information about the existing facts instead of supplying new facts, and it must be true for the argument to be valid.

For Example:

The Republican candidate for governor of State X will get the education vote. More than $200,000 was donated to her campaign fund by the state teachers' union. The same union donated only half that amount to the Democratic candidate's campaign.

You would then be asked to choose the statement that best reveals an assumption underlying the preceding argument.

1. The Republican candidate is a former teacher.
2. The Democratic candidate will lose the election.
3. A donation usually indicates approval of a candidate.
4. Most teachers have joined the union.
5. Unions endorse candidates in each election.

An excellent test of a Hidden Assumption is the “negation test”. If you think a choice is a Hidden Assumption, negate it and see if it seriously affects the validity of the conclusion – the right answer should.

For example, suppose you are struggling between answer (3) and (4). If answer (4) was falsified, you would now have the statement “Most teachers have not joined the union.” Does that mean that the Republican candidate is now likely not to win the education vote? She may still. Negation of answer (3) gives you “Donations usually don’t indicate approval of a candidate.” This negative statement does the most direct harm to the conclusion that the Republican candidate will get teachers' votes; it makes the connection between the facts and conclusion illogical. Answer (3) is correct.

Distracters associated with this question type include choices such as (4), which doesn't support the conclusion enough; as well as irrelevant statements such as (1), (2) and (5) besides being marginal to the problem, these statements also introduce new facts, whereas answer (3) elaborates on the facts given.

Try these questions.

11. In order to ensure a successful vote on the issue of abortion rights, the governor is pressuring the leaders of the state political party to replace several delegates to the national convention. The governor is insisting that certain individuals with a history of voting in favor of abortion be replaced with those who have voted against abortion rights in the past.

The governor's actions demonstrate that he is making which of the following assumptions?

1. Voting on abortion issues is an important part of the national political agenda.
2. The current delegates will probably not share the governor's views on such issues as the national budget or federal spending limits.
3. The proposed new delegates will continue to vote on abortion issues in the same way that have voted in the past.
4. The national delegation will not have an opportunity to vote on any issues other than abortion rights.
5. Governors of other states will be making similar changes to their states' delegations, so that the issue of abortion rights will be guaranteed to be decided as this governor desires.

12. To travel on public transportation from City Hall to the convention center, the most direct route requires passengers to ride the Blue Bus line to Center Street, collect a token at Center Street station, then ride the subway to Middle street. This weekend there will be a big political rally, so the city should hire extra token vendors for the Center Street station.

The conclusion for the preceding argument depends upon which of the following assumptions?

1. The mayor will be working at City Hall this weekend and will need to use public transportation to go to the convention center.
2. There is no way to get from City hall to the convention center without going through the Center street station.
3. The political rally will draw thousands of people to the city from all parts of the state.
4. Because of the political rally, traffic at the Center Street station will increase.
5. The city public transportation system does not allow passengers to buy tokens in advance.

13. The newspaper just reported that a man won this year's national baking contest for the first time in its history. The contest has used both male and female judges for many years. This must have been the first year that the contest was open to male participants.

Which of the following is an assumption upon which the speaker's conclusion is based?

1. The newspapers has never before reported the results of the national baking contest.
2. Male judges are more likely to vote for a male contestant than for a female contestant.
3. Men have tried to enter the national baking contest for several years but have been denied.
4. Men are generally superior to women and would be able to beat them in any kind of competition.
5. Men are better bakers than women and could win this contest ever year.

14. Today is Tuesday and yesterday was Monday. Therefore, tomorrow will be Wednesday.

This speaker's conclusion depends on which of the following assumptions?

1. Wednesday is the day that precedes Thursday.
2. Tuesday always follows Monday.
3. If, in any given week, Tuesday follows Monday, then Wednesday will follow Tuesday.
4. Every week consists of seven days arranged in a particular order.
5. The speaker always schedules a certain meeting to occur on Wednesday.

15. In the animal world, when any species becomes overpopulated, naturalists observe that the animals begin fighting among themselves and become cannibalistic. Sociologists have been reporting for years that the human population of the world is growing at an uncontrollable rate, and the world's cities will be overpopulated in about ten years. As a result human societies will begin experiencing a global breakdown and we can expect an international war within the next ten years.

Which of the following statements represents a hidden assumption upon which the preceding argument depends?

1. Human social behaviors follow the same pattern as the behaviors of animals.
2. Major cities do not always have adequate budgets to provided resources for all their residents.
3. Naturalists and sociologists use the same research methods in studying their subjects and reporting results.
4. The study that showed cannibalistic patterns in animals studied only carnivorous animals.
5. The population of the world has doubled in the past five years, and its rate of growth will increase even faster in the future.

"One of the great things about homeopathy is that because the remedies don't actually do anything there's no need to worry about nasty side effects."

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5.4 Analysis of Explanation Questions

Analysis of explanations questions test abilities used in explanation: flexibility in generating explanations and evaluating relevance in terms of them, and in assessing the explanatory adequacy of statements. Special subject matter knowledge is not required. Each group of analysis of explanations questions consists of a situation and results along with questions directed toward explaining the result, given the situation. The questions might be presented in the format illustrated below, in which two choices (A), (B) are available for each answer alternatively be, presented in a three-choice format (A, B, C) with directions to choose the best answer, or in a four-choice format (A, B, C, D) with directions to select a pair of choices from among the four choices.

Directions: preceding each group of numbered statements is a question that can be answered "Yes" or "No". Answer this question separately for each statement in the group by marking answer choice A on your answer sheet for “yes” or answer choice B for “No” next to the number for each statement. Be careful no to mark answer choices C, D or E. Do not assume either that there are more “Yes” answers or that there are more “No” answers.

Situation: The damming of the Palman River partially flooded the West Kenyan Wildlife Preserve and caused overcrowding of the animal population. Therefore, one hundred of the giraffes and one hundred of the Zimmerman gazelles were moved to the much larger East Kenyan preserve, where identical species of lions and giraffes as in the West Kenyan preserve and one species of gazelles, Allen gazelles, were already living. The only difference in climate was that the East Kenyan preserve averaged about ten inches less rain per year. In both preserves the prevailing winds were from the east, and the terrain was mainly flat.

Results: After three years in the East Kenyan preserve, the population of Zimmerman gazelles there had diminished almost to the point of extinction.

How this result arose from the given situation needs explanation.

You will be asked, for each of several statements, whether the statement is relevant to explaining how this result arose from the given situation. A statement is relevant if it provides information (beyond what is given in the situation) that either supports or, alternatively, weakens some possible adequate explanation.

You will also be asked, for each of several other statements, whether the statement could serve as a basis for explaining how this result arose from the given situation.

Do not consider extremely unlikely or farfetched explanations.

Question: In the following statement, if true, relevant to some possible adequate explanation of how the result arose from the given situation?

No zoo has succeeded in breeding Allen gazelles in captivity.

The weather was normal in East Kenya during the three years after the transfer.

Question: Could the following statement, if true, form the basis for an adequate explanation of how the result arose from the given situation?

The animals successful rounded up for the transfer included primarily the weaker Zimmerman gazelles, which then lost out in competition for grass with the Allen gazelles.

Kenya's efforts to increase hydroelectric power caused the overcrowding in the West Kenyan preserve.

6.1 Practice Questions

DIRECTIONS *for questions 1 – 10:* Write down the conclusions in the arguments that follow:

1. Two decades after the Emerald River Dam was built, none of the eight fish species native to the Emerald River was still reproducing adequately in the river below the dam. Since the dam reduced the annual range of water temperature in the river below the dam from 50 degrees to 6 degrees, scientists have hypothesized that sharply rising water temperatures must be involved in signaling the native species to begin the reproductive cycle.

2. Low-income families are often unable to afford as much child care as they need. One government program would award low-income families a refund on the income taxes they pay of as much as $1,000 for each child under age four. This program would make it possible for all low-income families with children under age four to obtain more child care than they otherwise would have been able to afford.

3. In Asia, where palm trees are non -native, the trees' flowers have traditionally been pollinated by hand, which has kept palm fruit productivity unnaturally low. When weevils, known to be efficient pollinators of palm flowers, were introduced into Asia in 1980, palm fruit productivity increased - by up to fifty percent in some areas - but then decreased sharply in 1984.

4. Although custom prosthetic bone replacements produced through a new computer-aided design process will cost more than twice as much as ordinary replacements, custom replacements should still be cost-effective. Not only will surgery and recovery time be reduced, but also replacements should last longer, thereby reducing the need for further hospital stays.

5. Extinction is a process that can depend on a variety of ecological, geographical, and physiological variables. These variables affect different species of organisms in different ways, and should, therefore, yield a random pattern of extinctions. However, the fossil record shows that extinction occurs in a surprisingly definite pattern, with many species vanishing at the same time.

6. A famous singer recently won a lawsuit against an advertising firm for using another singer in a commercial to evoke the famous singer's well-known rendition of a certain song. As a result of the lawsuit, advertising firms will stop using imitators in commercials. Therefore, advertising costs will rise, since famous singers' services cost more than those of their imitators.

7. The fewer restrictions there are on the advertising of legal services, the more the lawyers there are who advertise their services and the lawyers who advertise a specific service usually charge less for that service than lawyers who do not advertise. Therefore, if the state removes any of its current restrictions, such as the one against advertisements that do not specify fee arrangements, overall consumer legal cost will be lower than if the state retains its current restriction.

8. With the emergence of biotechnology companies, it was feared that they would impose silence about proprietary results on their in-house researchers and their academic consultants. This constraint, in turn, would slow the development of biological science and engineering.

9. Neither a rising standard of living nor balanced trade, by itself, establishes a country's ability to compete in the international marketplace. Both are required simultaneously since standards of living can rise because of growing trade deficits and trade can be balanced by means of a decline in a country's standard of living.

10. For the safety-conscious Swedish market, a United States manufacturer of desktop computers developed a special display screen that produces a much weaker electromagnetic field surrounding the user than do ordinary screens. Despite an advantage in this respect over its competitors, the manufacturer is introducing the screen into the United States market without advertising it as a safety improvement.

DIRECTIONS ***for questions 11 – 22:*** In the options that follow the argument, choose the one that is most appropriate to the question that follows the argument.

11. Insurance Company X is considering issuing a new policy to cover services required by elderly people who suffer from diseases that afflict the elderly. Premiums for the policy must be low enough to attract customers. Therefore, Company X is concerned that the income from the policies would not be sufficient to pay for the claims that would be made.

Which of the following strategies would most likely minimize Company X's losses on the policies?

A. Attracting middle-aged customers unlikely to submit claims for benefits for many years.
B. Insuring only those individuals who did not suffer any serious diseases as children.
C. Including a greater number of services in the policy than are included in other policies of lower cost.
D. Insuring only those individuals who were rejected by other companies for similar policies.
E. Insuring only those individuals who are wealthy enough to pay for the medical services.

12. The technological conservatism of bicycle manufacturers is a reflection of the kinds of demand they are trying to meet. The only cyclists seriously interested in innovation and willing to pay for it are bicycle racers. Therefore, innovation in bicycle technology is limited by what authorities will accept as standard for purposes of competition in bicycle races.

Which of the following is an assumption made in drawing the conclusion?

A. The market for cheap, traditional bicycles cannot expand unless the market for high-performance competition bicycles expands.
B. High-performance bicycles are likely to be improved more as a result of technological innovations developed in small workshops than as a result of technological innovations developed in major manufacturing concerns.
C. Bicycle racers do not generate a strong demand for innovations that fall outside what is officially recognized as standard for purposes of competition.
D. The technological conservatism of bicycle manufacturers results primarily from their desire to manufacture a product that can be sold without being altered to suit different national markets.
E. The authorities who set standards for high-performance bicycle racing do not keep informed about innovative bicycle design.

13. Which of the following best completes the passage below?

Established companies concentrate on defending what they already have. Consequently, they tend not to be innovative themselves and tend to underestimate the effects of the innovations of others. The clearest example of this defensive strategy is the fact that _____

A. ballpoint pens and soft-tip markers have eliminated the traditional market for fountain pens, clearing the way for the marketing of fountain pens as luxury or prestige items.
B. a highly successful automobile was introduced by the same company that had earlier introduced a model that had been a dismal failure.
C. a once-successful manufacturer of slide rules reacted to the introduction of electronic calculators by trying to make better slide rules.
D. one of the first models of modern accounting machines, designed for use in the banking industry, was purchased by a public library as well as by banks.
E. the inventor of a commonly used anesthetic did not intend the product to be used by dentists, who currently account for almost the entire market for that drug.

14. There are fundamentally two possible changes in an economy that will each cause inflation unless other compensating changes also occur. There changes are either reductions in the supply of goods and services or increases in demand. In a prebanking economy the quantity of money available, and hence the level of demand, is equivalent to the quantity of gold available.

If the statements above are true, then it is also true that in a pre-banking economy

A. any inflation is the result of reductions in the supply of goods and services
B. if other factors in the economy are unchanged, increasing the quantity of gold available will lead to inflation
C. if there is a reduction in the quantity of gold available, then, other things being equal, inflation must result
D. the quantity of goods and services purchasable by a given amount of gold is constant
E. whatever changes in demand occur, there will be compensating changes in the supply of goods and services

15. To reduce costs, a company is considering drastic reduction in the number of middle-level managers. This reduction would be accomplished by first offering early retirement to those 50 years of age or older with 15 years of service, and then by firing enough of the others to bring the overall reduction to 50 percent.

Each of the following, assuming that it is a realistic possibility, is a possible disadvantage to the company of the plan EXCEPT

A. Loyalty to the company will be reduced among those surviving the reduction, because they will perceive the status of even good managers as uncertain.
B. The restructuring of managerial jobs will allow business units to be adapted to fit a changing business environment.
C. The company will have a smaller pool of managers from which to choose in selecting future senior managers.
D. Some of the best managers, unsure of their security against being fired, will choose early retirement.
E. The increased workload of managers remaining with the company will subject them to stress that will eventually affect their performance.

16. The local board of education found that, because the current physics curriculum has little direct relevance to today's world, physics classes attracted few high school students. So to attract students to physics classes, the board proposed a curriculum that emphasizes principles of physics involved in producing and analyzing visual images.

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest reason to expect that the proposed curriculum will be successful in attracting students?

A. Several of the fundamental principles of physics are involved in producing and analyzing visual images.
B. Knowledge of physics is becoming increasingly important in understanding the technology used in today's world.
C. Equipment that a large producer of photographic equipment has donated to the high school could be used in the proposed curriculum.
D. The number of students interested in physics today is much lower than the number of students interested in physics 50 years ago.
E. In today's world the production and analysis of visual images is of major importance in communications, business, and recreation.

17. Adult female rats who have never before encountered rat pups will start to show maternal behaviors after being confined with a pup for about seven days. This period can be considerably shortened by disabling the female's sense of smell or by removing the scent-producing glands of the pup.

Which of the following hypotheses best explains the contrast described above?

A. The sense of smell in adult female rats is more acute than that in rat pups.
B. The amount of scent produced by rat pups increases when they are in the presence of a female rat that did not bear them.
C. Female rats that have given birth are more affected by olfactory cues than are female rats that have never given birth.
D. A female rat that has given birth shows maternal behavior toward rat pups that she did not bear more quickly than does a female rat that has never given birth.

E. The development of a female rat's maternal interest in a rat pup that she did not bear is inhibited by the odor of the pup.

18. A study of marital relationships in which one partner's sleeping and waking cycles differ from those of the other partner reveals that such couples share fewer activities with each other and have more violent arguments than do couples in a relationship in which both partners follow the same sleeping and waking patterns. Thus, mismatched sleeping and waking cycles can seriously jeopardize a marriage.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument above?

A. Married couples in which both spouses follow the same sleeping and waking patterns also occasionally have arguments than can jeopardize the couple's marriage.
B. The sleeping and waking cycles of individuals tend to vary from season to season.
C. The individuals who have sleeping and waking cycles that differ significantly from those of their spouses tend to argue little with colleagues at work.
D. People in unhappy marriages have been found to express hostility by adopting a different sleeping and waking cycle from that of their spouses.
E. According to a recent study, most people's sleeping and waking cycles can be controlled and modified easily.

19. Biological functions of many plants and animals vary in cycles that are repeated every 24 hours. It is tempting to suppose that alteration in the intensity of incident light is the stimulus that controls these daily biological rhythms. But there is much evidence to contradict this hypothesis.

Which of the following, if known, is evidence that contradicts the hypothesis stated in the lines above?

A. Human body temperature varies throughout the day, with the maximum occurring in the late afternoon and the minimum in the morning.
B. While some animals, such as the robin, are more active during the day, others, such as mice, show greater activity at night.
C. When people move from one time zone to another, their daily biological rhythms adjust in a matter of days to the periods of sunlight and darkness in the new zone.
D. Certain single-cell plants display daily biological rhythms even when the part of the cell containing the nucleus is removed.
E. Even when exposed to constant light intensity around the clock, some algae display rates of photosynthesis that are much greater during daylight hours than at night.

20. Consumer income reports produced by the government distinguish between households and families by means of the following definition: "A family is a household containing a householder and at least one person related to the householder." Except for the homeless and people in group living quarters, most people live in households.

According to the definition above, which of the following must be true?

A. All householders are members of families.
B. All families include a householder.
C. All of the people related to a householder form a family.
D. Some people residing in group living quarters are members of families.
E. Some homeless people reside in group living quarters.

21. The most important aspect of moviemaking is conveying a scene's rhythm. Conveying rhythm depends less on the artistic quality of the individual photographic images than on how the shots go together and the order in which they highlight different aspects of the action taking place in front of the camera.

If the statements above are true, which of the following must be true on the basis of them?

A. The artistic quality of the individual photographic image is unimportant in movie photography.

B. Photographers known for the superb artistic quality of their photographs are seldom effective as moviemakers.
C. Having the ability to produce photographs of superb artistic quality does not in itself guarantee having the ability to be a good moviemaker.
D. Movie photographers who are good at their jobs rarely give serious thought to the artistic quality of the photographs they take.
E. To convey a scene's rhythm effectively, a moviemaker must highlight many different aspects of the action taking place.

22. In the aftermath of a worldwide stock-market crash, Country T claimed that the severity of the stock market crash it experienced resulted from the accelerated process of denationalization that many of its industries underwent shortly before the crash.

Which of the following, if it could be carried out, would be most useful in an evaluation of Country T's assessment of the causes of the severity of its stockmarket crash?

A. Calculating the average loss experienced by individual traders in Country T during the crash.
B. Using economic theory to predict the most likely date of the next crash in Country T.
C. Comparing the total number of shares sold during the worst days of the crash in Country T to the total number of shares sold in Country T just prior to the crash.
D. Comparing the severity of the crash in Country T to the severity of the crash in countries otherwise economically similar to Country T that have not experienced recent denationalization.
E. Comparing the long-term effects of the crash on the purchasing power of the currency of Country T to the immediate, more severe short-term effects of the crash on the purchasing power of the currency of Country T.

CLICK HERE FOR CHECKING YOUR ANSWERS

Quiz Keys and Explanations

Identifying Conclusions Quiz

1. **The FDA should stop all cigarette sales immediately**. After all, cigarette smoking is the leading preventable cause of death.
2. **Every law is an evil**, for every law is an infraction of liberty.
3. Wisdom is the principal thing, therefore **get wisdo**m.
4. Now human law is framed for a multitude of human beings. The majority of human beings are not perfect in virtue. Therefore **human laws do not forbid all vices**.
5. ... **vicious acts are contrary to acts of virtue**. But human laws does not prohibit all vices... Therefore neither does it prescribe all acts of virtue.
6. The real and original source of inspiration for the Muslim thinkers was the Quran and the sayings of the Holy Prophet. It is therefore clear that **the Muslim philosophy was not a carbon copy of Greek thought**, as it concerned itself primarily and specifically with those problems which originated from and had relevance to Muslims.
7. **Letting forests die is self destructive**. Their role as a filter of the world's pollution, a sponge that absorbs carbon dioxide and slows global warming is crucial to the life of the earth.
8. As the government spends increasingly less on student financial aid, many leading colleges and universities are using a larger percentage of tuition revenues for scholarships. Just as income tax breaks are given for charitable contributions, **this portion of the tuition should be tax deductible**.
9. If the criminal law prohibits suicide, that is not an argument valid in the church; and besides, **the prohibition is ridiculous**; for what penalty can frighten a person who is not afraid of death itself?
10. If **a right to euthanasia is grounded in self determination, it cannot be reasonably limited to the terminally ill**. If people have a right to die, why must they wait till they are dying before they are permitted to exercise that right?
11. The dreamer rejected the ordinary. Jay invited the ordinary. **Jay was no dreamer.**
12. The future is uncertain, so do whatever you want to do it, do it now.
13. Take sabbaticals; it will benefit you and the society.
14. You cannot have accountability without responsibility.
15. Rule based organizations run well when environment is stable, but dynamic environments require more of innovation than rules.
16. Revolution is a better way of problem-solving than evolution.
17. Mankind is obsessed with the brain – neglecting the rest of the body.
18. We live to enjoy life – everything that we do does not necessarily have to have rational reasons.
19. Leaders are not made by hierarchies, real leaders are people who care about others.
20. Fee should be proportional to the income that you end up earning after the course.
21. In the knowledge economy, meaning, ownership et al are more important than efficiency and productivity.

Identifying Fallacies Quiz

1. *Appeal to inappropriate authority*
2. *Circular Reasoning*
3. *Complex question*
4. *Ignorance*
5. Correlation not cause:
6. *Ad Hominem – Against the person*
7. *Of sampling*
8. *Equivocation*
9. *Circular Reasoning*
10. *Composition*
11. *Ambiguity*
12. *Syllogism:*
13. *Bad analogy:*
14. *Circular Reasoning*
15. *Complex question*

Types of Questions

Answer Key

Types of Questions	
1.	4
2.	2
3.	5
4.	3
5.	2
6.	4
7.	4
8.	5
9.	3
10.	4
11.	3
12.	4
13.	5
14.	3
15.	1

Explanations

1. In this question, the basic issue is the effect of size on consumer service. Option 1 talks of insurance but the relation between insurance of deposit and consumer service can't be established.
Option 2 is actually going to increase the instances of mergers leading to a heightening of the consumers fears.
Option 3 seems of at first glance but the moot question here is about service and not return.
Option 4 gives us reason to believe that bigger banks offer better service than smaller banks – so that they actually reduce the consumer's fear. Right option.
Option 5 talks about government controlled banks whereas the equation is talking about community banks.

2. The conclusion here is that the measure of the quality of the school is the percentage of students it sends to college.
A strong assumption over here is that when students join school they all have the same intellect.
Option 2 casts aspersions on this assumption, hence on the quality of Governor Smith Academy.

3. Assumption: The quality of art supplies is the main determinant of a work of art.
Conclusion: Using Acme's art material will make you a better painter than da Vinci.
Option 5 provides evidence of contradiction of the main assumption, hence it points out the flaw in the claim.

4. Conclusion: There is an improvement in the economy.
Assumption: Total number of new jobs is a good indicator of economic conditions. If you have new jobs which have lesser pay and benefits substituting old jobs, then the overall economy would suffer.
This evidence is introduced by option 3.

5. Conclusion: High levels of niacin in the diet is good for health.
Assumption: There are no side – effects. The sample is representative of the population.
Option 2 tells us that sample is not one of healthy people – so we cannot generalize the results of this study.
Option 1 talks of a different study so it is not relevant.

6. Conclusion: U.S. banking deregulation has helped improve profits of banks, whilst offering high rates for deposits and low rates for borrowers.
Option 4 talks of this and so is the right option.

7. Conclusion: Deficit increased in 1995 compared to 1994, without any changes in costs. Now deficit is a function of funds received and funds spent.
Option 4 indicates that 95 saw a dip in funds received and hence accounts for the increased deficit.

8. The conditions can be symbolized as
Boardwalk Hotel→ Boardwalk, Park Place
Marvin gardens Hotel → Marvin Gardens
: Park Place→ : Boardwalk Hotel
Hence option 5.

9. Data can be tabulated as below:

Water – X Temp Hi	X	Y
	Const.	Hi
Water – Y Temp Hi	--	Const

10. Conclusion: 70% municipal employees Insure with Green Arrow.
Inference: Green Arrow must be seen to be Value – For – Money for this to happen. Hence option 4.
The advertiser quotes this statistic to imply the message stated in the inference.

11. Conclusion: To get a successful vote you need to have a higher number of delegates with past record of supporting your cause.
Assumption: The past is a good indicator of future.
Option 3 mentions the same.

12. Conclusion: There will be a rush at Centre Street stations this weekend.
Assumption: most commuters will prefer the Centre Street route.
Option 2 seems to be tantalizing – but option 4 is a very basic truth that has a much closer relevance to the conclusion.

13. Conclusion: the baking contest was till last year only open to women.
Assumption: Men are more skilled at baking.
Option 4 is a more general statement of skills.
Option 5 has a more direct reference to baking and is the choice.

14. Conclusion: Tomorrow is Wednesday.
Assumption: Wednesday s come after Tuesday s.
Option 3 is the only one that directly states the same.

15. Conclusion: There will be a global breakdown within the next 10 years.
Assumption: Behaviour of men and animals in overcrowding will be the same.
Option 1 states the same correct answer.
Option 2 justifies the argument but is not an assumption.
Option 3 is a weak assumption.
Option 4 is a play of words - herbivores cannot be cannibalistic.
Option 5 states a fact that is only restating what is mentioned in the question.

Practice Questions

1. Sharply rising water temperatures must be involved in signaling the native species to begin the reproductive cycle.
2. Program would make it possible for all low-income families with children under age four to obtain more child care than they otherwise would have been able to afford.
3. Weevils increased palm fruit productivity initially, but then it decreased.
4. Custom replacements should still be cost-effective.
5. Extinction occurs in a surprisingly definite pattern.
6. Advertising costs will rise with the ban.
7. If the state removes any of its current restrictions, overall consumer legal cost will be lower
8. Emergence of biotechnology companies, will slow the development of biological science and engineering.
9. Rising standard of living and balanced trade are both required to establish a country's ability to compete in the international marketplace.
10. Manufacturer is introducing the screen into the US market without advertising it as a safety improvement.

Answer Key 11-22

Practice Questions	
11.	A
12.	C
13.	C
14.	B
15.	B
16.	E
17.	E
18.	D
19.	E
20.	B
21.	C
22.	D

Explanations 11- 22

11. Option A.

Conclusion: The new policy for elderly people will make losses because claims would be more than premia.

Watch out for: If the company's losses have to reduce, it has to be either able to increase premium or reduce coverage costs.

A – is increasing premium income as these people will pay for a longer time
B – Disease in childhood and old age may not be linked
C – This will raise coverage cost
D – These are riskier individuals – so coverage cost will increase
E – Not relevant, since the company has to pay costs, irrespective of the financial condition of the insured.

12. Option C.

Conclusion: Low innovation in cycle industry is because racing rules have not changed much over the years.

Watch out for: Non racers are not interested in innovation; Racers are only interested in those innovations which are defined by competition rules.

A – The passage is more about innovation than demand.
B – Small workshop technology is not in the scope of the argument
C – Is an important assumption because it links argument and premise.
D – Is offering an alternate reason – and not highlighting an assumption.
E – Is negating the conclusion – because then in this case, even racing would not drive innovation.

13. Option C.

Conclusion: Established companies don't innovate as they are busy defending what they have.

Watch out for: An example where an established company was driven out because of innovation by competitors.

A – The fountain pen industry managed to survive.
B – Failure and innovation both happened in the same company
C – The fact that most readers don't even know what a slide rule looks like is indication of the industry's death. It was a logarithm based calculator – and was replaced by electronic calculators.
D – Is talking about multiple usage – not decline.
E – Is about the death of a usage, not the product.

14. Option B.

Conclusion: Inflation can be also compensated by supply of money.

Watch out for: Discovery of new gold mines, If no new gold, then Price * qty = constant.

A – Can also result from increased demand.
B – New Gold!
C – Deflation would result with reduced money supply.
D – Which means that price is constant.. but then that is not what inflation is!
E – If money supply is constant.

15. Option B.

Conclusion: The best way to cut costs is to fire middle level managers.

Watch out for: Very few middle managers, good people leaving, Morale down

A – Morale down
B – More flexibility is an advantage!
C – Loss of talent pool
D – The good will leave
E – More stress in the workforce

16. Option E.

Conclusion: The best way to attract students to a subject is by having visual content.
Watch out for: Making and analyzing visual content gives a practical connect to a subject.

A – How visual content is produced is not related to interest in the content.
B – Is an assumption made by the board of education – but not relevant to student interest
C – Do all schools have this equipment?
D – All the more why we need more physics students – but again irrelevant to interest.
E – Gives us the Practical connect!

17. Option E.
Conclusion: Mother rats identify their pups by smell.
Watch out for: Ditto as above.

A – Nothing stated about the smell comparison between adult females and pups.
B – Again not stated
C – All the female rats in the experiment were not mothers
D – Same as above.
E – Explains the time taken to adjust with smell sense on – and reduction with it off.

18. Option D.
Conclusion: Mismatched sleeping and waking cycles can jeopardize a marriage.
Watch out for: Other causes for marital discord could be insecure jobs, amnesia.

A – A single swallow does not a summer make!
B – But they may still not match
C – Looks interesting. If office behavior correlates with home behavior. But nothing given about this.
D – Cause, not effect.
E – Does not connect with the argument – you do need to change your cycle with the job.

19. Option E.
Conclusion: Biological functions are stimulated by light.
Watch out for: Examples of functions that don't change with light.

A – Varies with light.
B – Maybe positively or negatively correlated – but still correlated.
C – Reinforces the main point – about light stimulus
D – Non-sequitur.
E – Shows that light stimulus not as important as time stimulus.

20. Option B.
Conclusion: A family is a household containing a householder and at least one person related to the householder.
Watch out for: Examples of legitimate families. Syllogisms.

A – We can have a single householder. It is not a family then.
B – By definition.
C – A man's sister, if she does not stay in the household, is not family.
D – Not necessarily true
E – Not related to household.

21. Option C.
Conclusion: Rhythm in movies comes from sequence of action shots.
Watch out for: Comparison between order and quality

A – Is an absolute statement. We are looking at relative merits.
B – Syncs with stmt A – ruled out for same reason
C – Logical fit. Good photographer does not necessarily make good movie maker.
D – Not necessarily true
E – Not talking about the sequence of shots.

22. Option D.
Conclusion: Denationalization led to stock market crash.
Watch out for: Other reasons for crash

A – We are looking at the cause – not the severity
B – Prediction will come after cause has been understood
C – But what about the price at which the shares were sold?
D – Having a benchmark will help us if ceterus paribus the effect was because of denationalization.
E – How does long term help when we are looking at the cause of the crash?